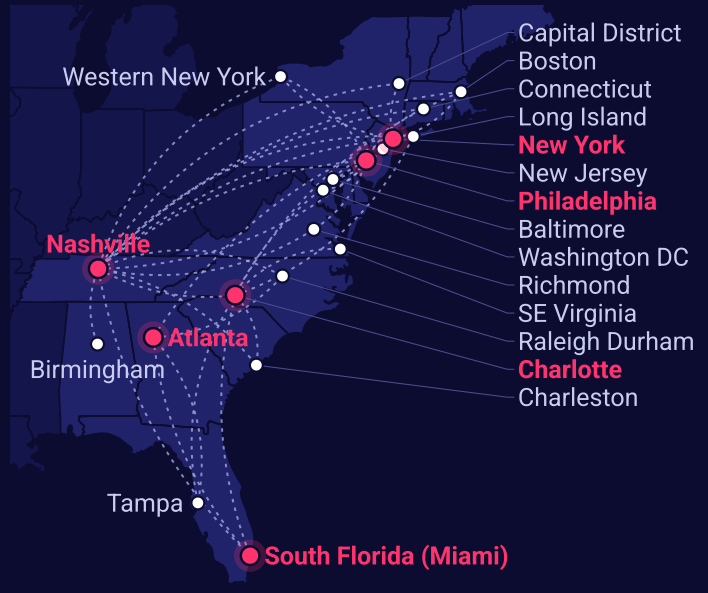


REGIONAL TRAINING EXPERIENCE · A PILOT TO TEST

Their first EO trip could be their forum training.

Picture your newest member a month after joining. They fly to a host city, and that night they are in a private dining room at a MICHELIN-starred or equivalent restaurant with new members from several chapters, the trainer, and the host chapter's leaders. The next day they train, and they catch an early evening flight home. **One night away. One chapter hosts each quarter. Every chapter sends its new class.**



EO US East, 21 chapters. Sample host cities in pink; any chapter can host.

- 21** chapters in US East
- 4** training dates a year, one per quarter
- 1** night away from home
- 95%*** member retention

THE EXPERIENCE

Simple: fly to a host city, have dinner with the host chapter's leaders at a MICHELIN-starred or equivalent restaurant, train for a full day, and catch an early evening flight home.



AT THE DINNER

- Why we joined EO.**
The trainer is there and facilitates a conversation about why everyone at the table joined.
- Advice from tenured leaders.**
The trainer interviews the host chapter's tenured members and leaders: their best EO experiences, and what new members should do to get involved sooner rather than later.
- The owner stops by.**
Restaurant owners are often EO members, and they come out to talk about their business model and entrepreneurial journey.

WHAT NEW MEMBERS GET

- Value on day one.** Right after they write their \$11,000-plus check, they are at a private MICHELIN-level dinner with EO leaders.
- A real sense of how big EO is,** and friends in other chapters who keep showing up at regional events.

WHAT CHAPTERS GET

- A full training room.** No \$250-per-person fees for empty seats.
- Better retention.** Forum members who visit outside their chapter renew at 95%.*

EXAMPLE PACKAGE: NASHVILLE

EO-owned and MICHELIN-recognized.

What a Nashville-hosted Regional Training Experience could look like. Other host cities build their own package.

DINNER: EO-OWNED, ONE MICHELIN STAR (2025)

 **Locust**
12 South

 **Catbird Seat**
Chef's counter

 **Bastion**
Same ownership group

ALSO EO-OWNED: MICHELIN RECOMMENDED (2025)

Tailor

Vivek Surti's South Asian tasting menu, Germantown

TRAINING DAY

 **Private social club**
or a boutique hotel meeting room

COSTS AND BUDGET

The savings: trainings under six people cost a chapter \$250 per person. A full regional room avoids it.

One pool

Any chapter that sends a member pays a set fee per member into one pool for the dinner and the trainer's travel (no travel if you pick the trainer's city).

Flights

Each chapter decides: the new member pays, the chapter offers a discount, or the chapter picks up the full tab.

Training room

A private social club or a boutique hotel, arranged by the host chapter.

Upside

Open seats can go to chapters in other regions at about \$500 each.



Give prospects the dates. Every chapter shares the year's Regional Training Experience dates with its prospects as soon as they start the application, so they save the dates before they join. Right after they write their \$11,000-plus check, they are in a private dining room at a MICHELIN-starred restaurant with EO leaders. They feel the value right away, and they capture the uniqueness and quality of EO membership.

WHAT TRAINERS GET

-  **Easier scheduling.** Less fighting over the same dates, and fewer preferred trainers capped out before July 1.
-  **Fewer trips.** One full room instead of several small ones, and no travel at all when the training is in their home city.

WHAT THE REGION GETS

-  **Connected chapters.** New members meet across chapter lines from their first month.
-  **A signature experience.** Something every US East prospect hears about before they join.

Run it as a pilot.

Test it this year. Ask the region for Forum, Membership, or Engagement funds to offset some of the costs.

*Prior data: a member who has visited an event outside their local chapter and is in forum has a 95% renewal rate. MICHELIN designations from the 2025 MICHELIN Guide American South.